

2000-63

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

(This is a two-page report. Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.)

Each table cell will automatically enlarge as you type!

Rec'd 2/5/01 wjpl

CFO-RC FILE X:

RESULTS:

Species:(Common Name): GREAT BLACK-BACKED GULL		(Scientific Name) <i>Larus marinus</i>
Date(s) of occurrence: 12 November 2000 and 16 December 2000		
Number of birds seen: One (presumed)	Sex: Unknown	Plumage: Adult
Exact Location: Cherry Creek Reservoir on 12 November and at Pueblo Reservoir on 16 December		
County: Arapahoe and Pueblo Counties	Nearest town: Denver (Cherry Creek) and Pueblo West (Pueblo Reservoir)	Elevation:
Length of observation: Roughly 10 minutes for each observation date.	Time(s) of observation: Roughly 9:30 AM at Cherry Creek and 10 AM at Pueblo Reservoir.	
Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: Tony Leukering and Michael Patten at Cherry Creek and Doug Faulkner at Pueblo Reservoir.		
Other Observers who independently saw the bird(s): Many		
Light Conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s); position: Clear on both observation days with sun to side of me.		
Optical equipment used: 8x40 Binoculars		
Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): Approximately 250 feet (at Cherry Creek) and 150 feet at Pueblo Reservoir		
Was bird(s) photographed? Yes (at Pueblo Reservoir)	If so, have you submitted photos? Yes	
Who took the photographs? Larry Semo		
Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred: Standing on tires of docks at both Cherry Creek and Pueblo Reservoir, both open water lakes.		
Describe the bird's behavior (flying, feeding, habits, behaviors used in identifying the Species or in supporting the identification):		
Describe the bird in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include the overall size and shape and how you placed the bird in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird(s). Describe other important details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the identification. (Fill out this portion even if photographs are submitted; you may attach additional sheets, drawings, field sketches or copy field notes):		
This bird is undoubtedly the same individual that has returned to Pueblo Reservoir (stopping first at Cherry Creek Reservoir) for years. At both locales, the bird was observed standing only but did stretch its' wings out occasionally. The following represents traits observed in the field. Overall Size and Shape: Extremely large size, much larger than nearby California and Ring-billed Gulls. When outstretched, the wings were long and broad. Bill: Very thick and long (massive) yellow bill with red gonydeal angle. Gonydeal angle not as strong as Western or Yellow-footed Gulls. Head and neck: White with no streaking noted. Yellow eyes. Underparts: Breast, belly, undertail coverts, and tail white Upperparts: Mantle and wings black except for white tertial band Folded Primaries: Slightly darker primaries than back and remainder of upper wings. Noticeably large white mirrors present on primary tips. Legs: Light pink		
Describe bird's call or song: None heard		

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them:

Other dark-mantled (black) large gulls found in North America include Western, Lesser Black-backed, Slaty-backed, Kelp, and Yellow-footed.

Western Gull: Southern race *wymani* is similar in appearance but smaller, even thicker bill (relatively), deeper gonydeal angle, and slightly lighter mantle

Lesser Black-backed: Much smaller with yellow legs, a thinner bill, and heavy head and neck streaking in winter.

Slaty-backed: Possesses heavy head and neck streaking in winter, brighter pink legs, a lighter mantle shade, is a smaller bird, and has a less massive bill.

Kelp Gull: Usually doesn't show white mirrors in folded primaries, is much smaller, and has greenish legs.

Yellow-footed Gulls: Smaller than Great Black-backed with bright yellow (not pink) legs, deeper gonydeal angle, and has only very small white mirrors to the folded primaries.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? Have observed countless others on the East Coast, Wisconsin, Minnesota, Texas, Colorado, and in Europe.

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation):

This report is from notes made during or after XX observation or later from memory

Date of written report: 01/30/01

Reporting observer: Larry Semo

Signature:



Reporting Observer's Address: 9054 Dover Street

City: Westminster

State: Colorado

Zip: 80021

Send report to:
Colorado Birds Record Committee
c/o Bill Lisowsky
2919 Silverplume Dr.
Ft. Collins, Co. 80526



Greater Black-backed
Gull

@ Pueblo

Larry Sarno

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